Event Storming

Map a business domain as a timeline of events with everyone who knows it, to find shared understanding, gaps and boundaries.

Engineering Practices · Event Storming (Alberto Brandolini) · Big Picture · Process · Design

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

DOMAIN: Online grocery order

DATE: 15 April

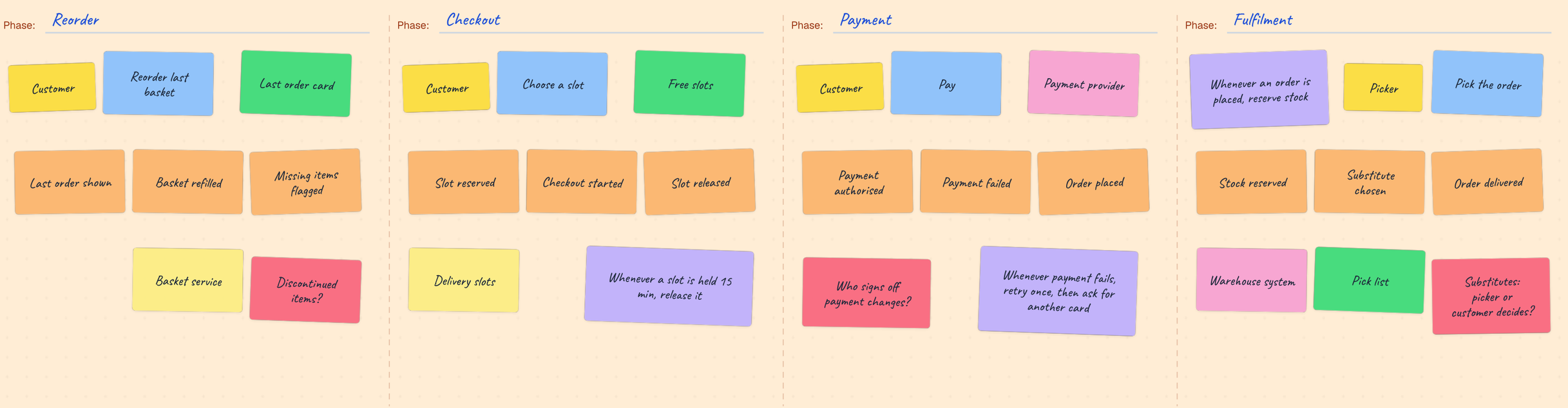
1 Sticky Key

ONE COLOUR PER KIND OF STICKY

- **Domain event** — Something that happened, in the past tense
- **Command** — A request or decision that causes an event
- **Actor** — The person or role who issues a command
- **Policy** — "Whenever this happens, we do that"
- **System** — What accepts a command and records the event
- **External system** — Something outside we depend on
- **Read model** — Information someone needs to decide
- **Hotspot** — A question, risk, gap or disagreement

2 The Timeline

EVENTS FIRST · THEN ORDER · THEN THE REST



TIME

Orange events left to right in time, other colours around them · Dashed lines mark pivotal events, where the story changes phase

3 Hotspots

TO RESOLVE, NOT IGNORE

QUESTION OR PROBLEM	OWNER
Discontinued items in a reorder?	Priya
Who signs off payment changes?	Payments lead
Substitutes: picker or customer decides?	Store Ops

4 Boundaries We Found

CANDIDATE CONTEXTS

AREA	KEY EVENTS	TEAM
Basket	Basket refilled, items flagged	Basket
Checkout and slots	Slot reserved, slot released	Checkout
Payments	Authorised, failed	Payments

5 Next Steps

ZOOM IN WHERE IT MATTERS

Zoom into (process or design): Failed payments (design)

Who to invite next: Payments lead, a picker from Store Ops

Next session: Tuesday 22 April, 2 hours

"What happens in this domain, in the order it really happens?"

"Where do people disagree about what happens next?"

© 2026 Eric Parker · CC BY 4.0 · eparker71.github.io/better-delivery-toolkit